

CHIEF INVESTMENT OFFICE

Capital Market Outlook

August 3, 2026

All data, projections and opinions are as of the date of this report and subject to change.

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Macro Strategy—Still Waiting for Europe: Two Years Post-Draghi Report: Nearly two years after the release of the landmark “Draghi report” in September 2024, the progress report isn’t pretty. An estimated 15.7% of the report’s recommendations have been implemented, up modestly from 11.2% a year ago. That’s tough news for a continent battling to maintain economic influence. Indeed, while America’s share of global output has remained resilient in the face of China’s rise over the last two decades, Europe’s share has not. Chief among the forces working against Europe in recent years has been so-called “China Shock 2.0”: an ongoing onslaught of exports targeted at both low- and high-value goods. In part due to protectionism from the U.S., China’s overflow of goods has increasingly been routed to Europe—so much so that China’s trade surplus with the European Union (EU) has now surpassed its surplus with the U.S. Whereas America’s manufacturing sector proved the primary victim of China Shock 1.0, Europe has emerged as the poster child of China Shock 2.0 with its manufacturing sector feeling the pain of low-cost competition in everything from electric vehicles to chemicals to pharmaceuticals. With China Shock 2.0 intensifying, energy vulnerabilities, lagging productivity, and limited Artificial Intelligence (AI) innovation, our preference for the U.S. over the old continent remains unchanged.

Market View—No More Surprises—Six “Surprises” That Shouldn’t Surprise Investors: From unsettled geopolitics to fractured global supply chains to AI disruptions, investors have had to navigate various crosscurrents over the past few years. Yet amid the gloom, the dire predictions of the worrywarts have repeatedly failed to materialize, “surprising” market bears. This week we outline six so-called “surprises” that shouldn’t surprise investors. One, the U.S. consumer refuses to quit, supported by immense purchasing power, rising home values, appreciating financial assets, solid wage gains and a dynamic labor market. Two, higher oil prices no longer break America thanks to a U.S. economy that’s more energy-efficient and less dependent on foreign supplies. Three, the U.S. dollar remains king, backstopped by the world’s largest government bond market, deepest capital markets, strongest property rights and broadest range of investable assets. Four, deficits matter, but America’s financing advantages, asset base, innovation and resilience provide time and flexibility. Five, corporate America keeps exceeding expectations by adapting, automating, restructuring, repricing and relentlessly pursuing productivity gains. Six, America remains one of the most shock-resistant economies in the world, helping markets adjust, reset and grind higher over the long run. The broader lesson for investors: Many so-called “surprises” are not surprises at all.

The Ticker Tape—Top Questions Answered Directly by Our Chief Investment Officer (CIO).

- Is the semiconductor and broader AI buildout chain capital investment cycle rolling over, and have we experienced the top in the cycle?

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Portfolio Considerations

The “Era of Transformation” is being driven by innovation, capital investment, infrastructure needs and evolving themes that extend from short-term resilience and earnings growth to longer-term Rebalancing, Re-globalization, Reconstruction and Rearmament.

Persistent shortages across AI-related resources, infrastructure, minerals and defense equipment are expected to support productivity, profit margins, asset-price growth and attractive potential opportunities across global equity markets, despite periodic “bullwhip” market volatility.

We remain overweight U.S. and Emerging Market Equities—favoring Industrials, Financials and Consumer Discretionary—while maintaining balanced exposure between Growth and Value—and views higher Fixed Income yields as attractive for income, diversification and risk compensation.

Still Waiting for Europe: Two Years Post-Draghi Report

Arianna Chiu, Assistant Vice President and Investment Strategist

"It's 'do this' or it's a slow agony." – Mario Draghi

So said the former European Central Bank president upon the release of his landmark "Draghi report" in September 2024. In the report, Draghi laid out over 380 recommendations for how Europe could reignite growth and avoid "slow agony" in the face of fracturing geopolitics, technological change and fierce competition from overseas.

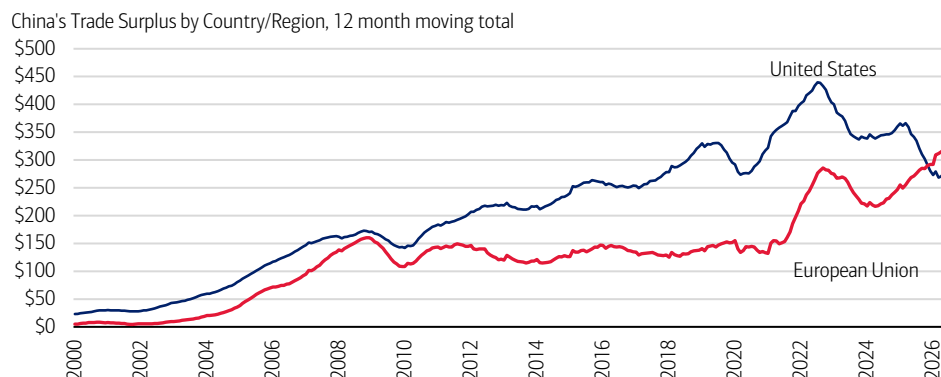
Nearly two years later, the progress report isn't pretty. The latest analysis from the European Policy Innovation Council (EPIC) suggests that just 15.7% of Draghi's recommendations have been implemented as of July 2026, a rather modest improvement from 11.2% a year ago. Some progress has been born of necessity, such as phasing out natural gas imports from Russia or spending more on defense. The more difficult reforms—stronger single market integration, unified capital markets, large-scale private investment, reducing critical material dependencies—are slow going. As EPIC concludes in its report, "the update confirms that Europe remains better at building legal architecture than at forcing market outcomes."

Those are tough words for a continent battling to maintain economic influence. According to figures from the International Monetary Fund, the EU and the UK (EU28) today make up 21% of global gross domestic product (GDP)—or roughly half the combined share of the U.S. (26%) and China (17%). Twenty years ago, the order looked different: EU28 accounted for 30% of world output, while the U.S. accounted for 27% and China a mere 5%. America's share of the global pie has remained resilient in the face of China's rise over the last two decades. Europe's share? Not so much.

Chief among the forces working against Europe in recent years has been so-called "China Shock 2.0". Unlike the first "China shock", which featured a surge in low-value merchandise exports (textiles, apparel, furniture, etc.) following China's accession to the World Trade Organization in 2001, the latest onslaught of exports has targeted both low-value and high-value goods (electric vehicles, batteries, advanced machinery, electronics, etc.). And while America's manufacturing sector was the primary victim of China Shock 1.0, Europe has emerged as the poster child of China Shock 2.0.

Case in point: China's widening trade surplus with the EU, now running at an annual pace of \$326 billion. That's more than double where it was entering this decade. In part due to protectionist measures from the U.S., China's overflow of goods has increasingly been routed to Europe and the rest of the world—so much so that, for the first time in history, China's trade surplus with the EU has surpassed its surplus with the U.S. (Exhibit 1). For comparison, at the start of the decade, China's surplus with the U.S. was nearly double its surplus with the EU.

Exhibit 1: China Shock 2.0 is All About Europe.



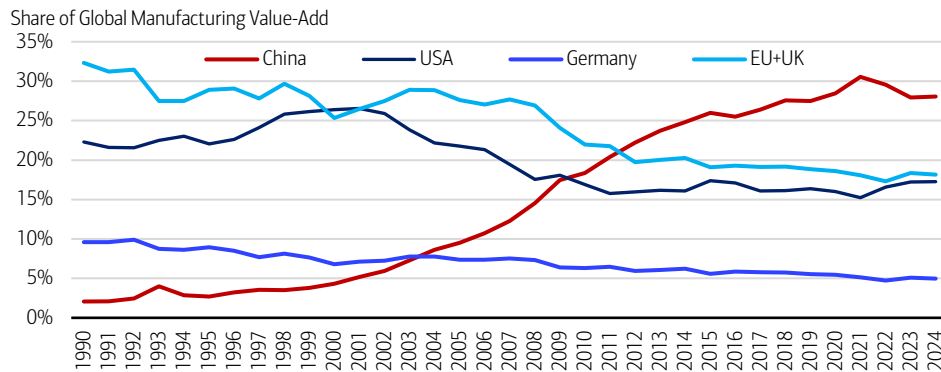
Source: China General Administration of Customs. Data through June 2026 as of July 14, 2026.

Investment Implications

We continue to prefer the U.S. and Emerging Markets over International Developed Equities. Manufacturing-led economies in Europe remain exposed to competition from China in key industries. Still, European markets can provide strategic exposure to Value and diversification away from mega-cap Technology stocks in portfolios.

Indeed, just as a flood of cheap imports from China gutted America's manufacturing base in the early-to-mid 2000s, Europe's manufacturing sector is feeling the pain of low-cost competition from China in everything from electric vehicles to chemicals to pharmaceuticals. Compared to China's near-30% share of global manufacturing output, the EU28's share has stagnated at roughly 18% of the global total, while Germany's has declined to 5% (Exhibit 2). Meanwhile, Chinese brands are gaining share where Europe cares most: in autos, for example, brands home to Beijing captured a record 10.9% of Europe's new car sales in June after out-selling Japan brands in Europe for the first time in May.¹ Surveys of European auto suppliers haven't been promising, either, with just 10% planning to increase production capacity in Western Europe over the next five years versus 49% in North America and 35% in China, according to the European Association of Automotive Suppliers and McKinsey

Exhibit 2: Europe and U.S. Lag in Share of Global Manufacturing.



Source: United Nations. Data as of July 2026.

And China's not the only culprit. Yes, huge government subsidies have turbocharged China's expansion across industries, with the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development estimating in June that subsidies alone explain nearly 60% of China firms' gain in global market share between 2005 and 2023. But a recent report from the European Trade Union Confederation points also to the more general "financialization" of Europe's largest companies—i.e., reorienting away from long-run productive investment in favor of short-run shareholder value. Owing in part to Europe's corporate tax system, corporations have increasingly absorbed profits into corporate balance sheets rather than recycling capital back into production and the broader economy. In fact, since 2009, the EU's non-financial corporate sector has saved more than it's invested, with net lending by corporations reaching 1.2% of the EU's GDP in 2024.²

Add low productive domestic investment to intense competition from China, and the case for Europe as a region ripe for future growth becomes a hard sell. Not helping matters: outside of its monopoly on extreme ultraviolet lithography (for now), the region has proven a relative bystander in the AI race while competition between frontier models out of the U.S. and China intensifies. Perhaps Brussels-based think tank Bruegel put it best: "Europe is, in effect, an indispensable input supplier to a race in which it does not itself compete."

All the reasons above support our tactical underweight to International Developed markets. Europe's bias toward sectors like Financials, Industrials and Healthcare can still be a helpful diversifier in portfolios in our view, particularly as Technology now accounts for 37% of the S&P 500 and 41% of the MSCI Emerging Markets Index versus 9% of the MSCI Europe Index. But with China Shock 2.0 intensifying, ongoing vulnerabilities to energy shocks, lagging productivity, and limited AI innovation, our preference for the U.S. over the old continent remains unchanged. Two years after Mario Draghi's landmark report, we're still waiting for Europe

¹ European Automobile Manufacturers' Association.

² For more, see "Labour Squeezed, Investment Stalled: The Hidden Cost of Financialisation in Europe's Corporate Sector" from the European Trade Union Confederation.

No More Surprises—Six “Surprises” That Shouldn’t Surprise Investors

Joseph Quinlan, *Managing Director and Head of Market Strategy*

Investors have had to navigate various crosscurrents over the past few years, ranging from unsettled geopolitics, to fractured global supply chains, to disruptions from AI. Each one of these forces—and others—has triggered a chorus of worry among market pessimists. Yet amid the gloom, something curious keeps happening—the dire predictions of the worrywarts never happen, disappointing and “surprising” market bears. From our vantage point, successful investing requires distinguishing between genuine surprises and developments that merely surprise those bearish on the U.S. In that spirit, we briefly outline six so-called “surprises” that shouldn’t surprise investors.

Surprise #1: The U.S. Consumer Refuses to Quit. To the “surprise” of many investors, U.S. consumers continue to spend—even in the face of rising inflation, higher interest rates, exploding credit card balances, debilitating levels of student loan debt and shaky consumer confidence. All these factors have lent support to those worrying about a consumer-led recession. However, what the bears miss is this: The reservoir of U.S. consumer purchasing power remains immense, backstopped by rising home values, appreciating financial assets, solid wage gains and a dynamic labor market. Yes, higher energy prices have caused consumers to trade down on products and services. And macro shocks cause consumers to postpone discretionary purchases but spending on services and essentials continues. This adaptability, along with exceptional underlying wealth, has long made betting against the American consumer a losing proposition.

Surprise #2: Higher Oil Prices No Longer Break America. Yes, crude oil prices matter, but they matter less in a U.S. economy that is more energy-efficient and less energy-dependent on foreign supplies. We are a long way from the 1970s and 1980s, when the U.S. was a significant importer of energy and thus vulnerable to repeated oil shocks that acted as a massive tax on households and businesses. Thanks to the shale revolution, the U.S. is now one of the world’s largest energy producers. This serves as a buffer to volatility in the Middle East, as well as a cushion to growth since when energy prices rise in the U.S., massive segments of the domestic economy—from Texas oil fields to infrastructure and equipment suppliers—thrive. Meanwhile, energy represents a much smaller share of household spending than it did decades ago. Modern vehicles are dramatically more fuel efficient, as is the U.S. economy, which generates more output from services, software, healthcare, finance and technology than from energy-intensive manufacturing. Higher oil prices still hurt consumers at the pump, but it is important to remember—or not be surprised—that America has become significantly less vulnerable to oil shocks due to a more diversified economy and expanding domestic energy production.

Surprise #3: The U.S. Dollar Remains King. Writing the obituary for the U.S. dollar is almost a cottage industry in the U.S., so imagine the “surprise” every time the greenback bounces back or becomes a safe-haven asset for investors in times of trouble. The dollar’s world reserve status continues due in large part to the fact that the U.S. possesses the world’s largest government bond market, deepest capital markets, strongest property rights, and broadest range of investable assets. The buck is also backstopped by the largest and most resilient economy in the world, which maintains a steady inflow of foreign capital into U.S. securities. Global trade, commodities, banking and financial contracts remain overwhelmingly denominated in dollars because the participants trust the institutions behind the currency. Meanwhile, Europe is weighed down by structural demographic challenges, sluggish growth, and strict regulations. China faces deep real estate vulnerabilities, regulatory unpredictability, and maintains a closed capital account. And the emerging markets carry volatile currency risks and political instability. The upshot for investors: stay long U.S. dollar-denominated assets and don’t be “surprised” by the enduring strength and attractiveness of the greenback.

Surprise #4: America’s Budget Deficit Has Not Triggered Financial Armageddon.

Trillion-dollar deficits, mounting debt and debt service levels, and relentless congressional borrowing continue to generate anxiety among investors and for good reasons. Deficits matter. But what matters more is America’s ability and capacity to service its deficit and debt, and on this basis, the U.S. is not staring down the barrel of financial Armageddon.

Investment Implications

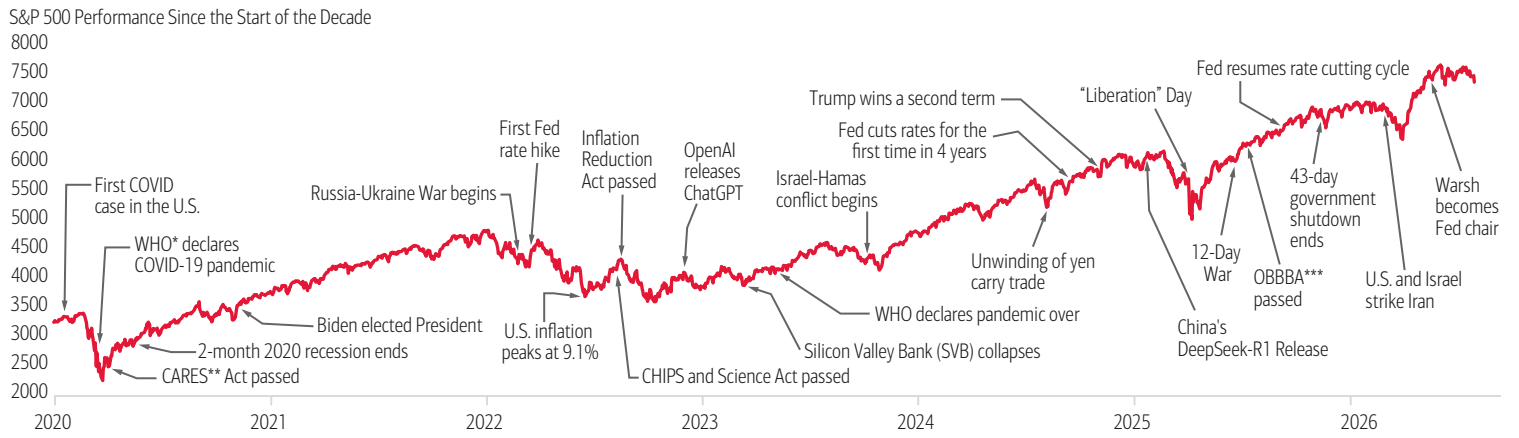
We maintain our overweight to U.S. Equities and U.S. dollar-denominated assets in portfolios owing to America’s unmatched capacity to drive productivity, embrace innovation, and absorb macro shocks. We’d use any bouts of volatility to add on weakness given still-strong fundamentals.

The U.S. possesses financing advantages unique to the rest of the world—it borrows in its own currency, its debt market remains the global benchmark for safety and liquidity, and Treasuries remain the world’s preferred reserve asset. In addition, America’s asset base is extraordinary: the economy remains the largest and most innovative in the world, supported by abundant natural resources, world-class universities, and an unmatched entrepreneurial ecosystem. All the above provides the U.S. the time, flexibility and resilience to run budget deficits—to the “surprise” of investors. On the assumption that U.S. nominal GDP, corporate profits, productivity, and tax revenues continue to grow faster than the government’s financing obligations, the debt markets are likely to tolerate U.S. deficit/debt levels that would be unsustainable almost anywhere else.

Surprise #5: U.S. Corporate Earnings Keep Exceeding Expectations. If there is one forecast that consistently “surprises” investors to the upside, it is the earnings power of Corporate America. Nearly every economic slowdown, interest-rate jolt, geopolitical crisis or policy scare is accompanied by downside profit warnings. Yet time after time, Corporate America has proven to be remarkably adept at exceeding expectations. That’s not surprising since U.S. firms are some of the most adaptive in the world. Faced with rising costs, firms automate, adopt new technologies, restructure operations, reskill workers, streamline supply chains, reprice products and services, and relentlessly pursue productivity gains. Standing still isn’t an option, nor is hoping for a government bailout or a favorable line of credit. In the U.S. ecosystem, you either adapt or die. The result is a corporate sector that continuously reinvents itself faster than analysts revise their forecasts. Just as important, the composition of corporate earnings has changed over the decades. Today’s largest companies derive significant value from software, data, intellectual property, brands, platforms and networks rather than heavy physical assets. These allow for scale, competitive moats, and higher profit margins. This structural shift has increased the resilience of corporate profits, to the “surprise” of many investors.

Surprise #6: America Remains One of the Most Shock-Resistant Economies in the World. The greatest “surprise” of all to investors is how well the U.S. economy has been able to absorb various macro shocks that have sunk, derailed or structurally impaired other economies. A pandemic, a ground war in the heart of Europe, sweeping U.S. tariffs on the global trading system, the closure of the Strait of Hormuz—what hasn’t been thrown at the economy and capital markets this decade? And yet, owing to America’s capacity to drive productivity, embrace innovation and relentlessly reinvent itself, U.S. nominal GDP thus far in the 2020s has increased a staggering \$10.5 trillion since the start of the decade. Meanwhile, as Exhibit 3 highlights, notwithstanding various macro shocks and jolts since 2020, the S&P 500 has continued to rise and climb—the direction, as we like to say, has been up and to the right. As of the end of July 2026, the S&P has managed a total return of 155%, which equates to annualized returns of 15.3%, above the historic average of 11.7% going back to 1945. Today, the ability to absorb shocks is all the more relevant as the markets question the credibility of the Warsh-led Federal Reserve (Fed) following last week’s Federal Open Market Committee meeting. Volatility and uncertainty have become near-term market staples. But that said, don’t be “surprised” to see the market adjust and reset and continue to grind higher over the long run.

Exhibit 3: Charting the Roaring and Roiling 2020s.



*World Health Organization. **Coronavirus Aid, Relief, and Economic Security Act. *** One Big Beautiful Bill Act. Source: Bloomberg. Data as of July 30, 2026. It is not possible to invest directly in an index. Please refer to index definitions at the end of this report. **Past performance is no guarantee of future results.**

Is the semiconductor and broader AI buildout chain capital investment cycle rolling over, and have we experienced the top in the cycle?

Christopher Hyzy, Chief Investment Officer

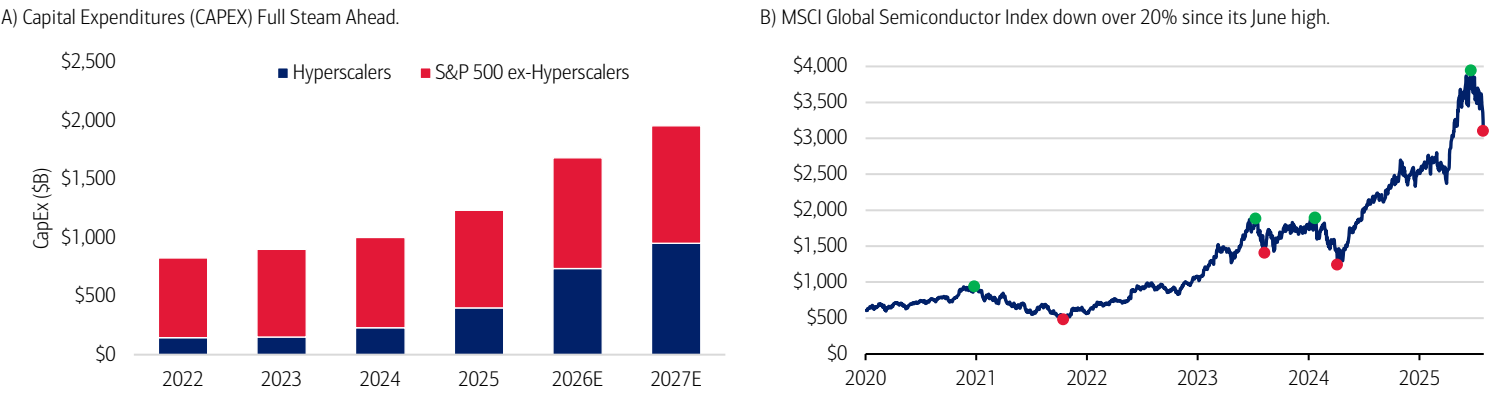
We don't believe the latest sharp downdraft across the semiconductor and AI buildout chain is a sign that the top from June is in. The components needed to acquire the necessary compute and power are still in short supply, while the capital investment spend is still increasing. Secondly, this area of the market has traditionally experienced corrections during "speed bump" periods as the computing innovation adjusts. Building the infrastructure as the innovation transitions from training to agentic to quantum and physical AI could enter periods that require tactical shifts. Ultimately, growth rates remain high as shortages in key areas still exist across the entire supply chain. Execution of this entire process given the coordination needed can have speed bumps. Do the speed bumps turn into major slowdowns and/or recessions? They can, but this is typically late cycle not early to mid as we are currently, in our view. In order to assess the magnitude of risk to the growth outlook, we will continue to closely watch both the associated spreads of debt financing that has been increasing as well as the insurance cost of protecting against defaults (credit default swaps–CDS) across the AI space in the coming months, particularly as longer dated Treasury yields pick up (as of July 29, 30-Year Treasury yields are now at their highest levels since 2007). Finally, we believe the sharp downdraft across the semiconductor and AI buildout chain was also exacerbated by a clearing event of over-levered investors that may have had to sell indiscriminately as the momentum in the space gathered steam in the past one to two weeks. Clearing events can help establish a more normal path forward in which investors begin to focus back on the fundamentals and less on trading and technicals.

As of late July, according to BofA Global Research, The MSCI Global Semiconductor Index had fallen more than 20% from recent June highs. Performance following past pullbacks since 1999 in global semis differ greatly depending on whether a recession follows. After previous pullbacks of similar magnitude, BofA Global Research also found that the average 12-month return was 44% when recession was avoided and 12% when a recession ensued. U.S. semis performed even better when a recession was avoided, rising 49%, but gained only 1% when a recession followed. None of the global cycle indicators show signs of an impending downturn. The signal from the Global Wave³ is positive for the sixth month. The global earnings revision ratio improved to 1.0, and, for global semis, the ratio sits at a four-and-a-half year high of 1.41. That said, recovery could take some time. On average, it took eight months for semis to recover the 14% pullback, seven months when recessions did not follow. Given the latest forward guidance by key leaders in the AI buildout space, we expect this cycle's recovery to be quicker than those experienced in the past. Overexposure to the semiconductor and capital equipment space became extended at the end of June, and this latest correction is more a sign of derisking than a sign of a large scale slow down.

Investment Implications

We expect the semiconductor-led pullback to be a temporary derisking event rather than a major slowdown, supporting a faster recovery than in past cycles. We believe the recent market volatility appears to be a potential buying opportunity rather than a reason to stay on the sidelines.

Exhibit 4: Speed Bumps are Normal, Keep an Eye on Fundamentals.



E=estimate. Exhibit 4A) Hyperscalers: Amazon, Google, Meta, Microsoft, Oracle. Source: FactSet. Data as of July 30, 2026. Exhibit 4B) Green dots represent peak. Red dots represent drawdowns of more than 20% from its peak. Source: Bloomberg. Data as of July 29, 2026. It is not possible to invest directly in an index. Please refer to index definitions at the end of this report. **Past performance is no guarantee of future results.**

³ BofA Global Research model to assess trends in the global economy.

MARKETS IN REVIEW

Equities

Equities	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	WTD	MTD	YTD
DJIA	52,485.03	1.0	0.4	10.2
NASDAQ	25,373.85	1.6	-3.2	9.5
S&P 500	7,489.72	1.1	-0.1	10.1
S&P 400 Mid Cap	3,758.64	-0.7	-2.4	14.5
Russell 2000	2,931.34	0.1	-3.0	18.9
MSCI World	4,847.88	1.2	0.5	10.3
MSCI EAFE	3,176.14	2.0	2.0	11.6
MSCI Emerging Markets	1,665.89	2.4	-3.1	20.0

Fixed Income[†]

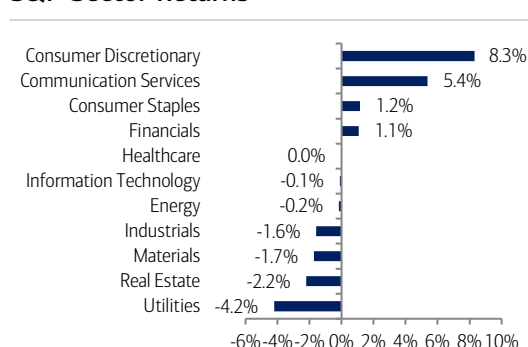
Fixed Income	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	WTD	MTD	YTD
Corporate & Government	4.88	-0.09	-1.29	-0.80
Agencies	4.59	0.09	-0.36	0.25
Municipals	3.93	0.13	-1.85	0.43
U.S. Investment-Grade Credit	4.98	-0.12	-1.30	-0.69
International	5.46	-0.06	-1.67	-0.83
High Yield	7.41	0.18	-0.25	1.71
90 Day Yield	3.75	3.90	3.81	3.63
2 Year Yield	4.29	4.33	4.17	3.47
10 Year Yield	4.73	4.68	4.47	4.17
30 Year Yield	5.27	5.16	4.95	4.84

Commodities & Currencies

Commodities	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	WTD	MTD	YTD
Bloomberg Commodity	339.73	-2.1	7.5	23.0
WTI Crude \$/Barrel ^{††}	84.67	-5.2	21.8	47.5
Gold Spot \$/Ounce ^{††}	4046.15	-0.2	1.0	-6.3

Currencies	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	Prior Week End	Prior Month End	2025 Year End
EUR/USD	1.15	1.14	1.14	1.17
USD/JPY	157.40	163.83	162.55	156.71
USD/CNH	6.75	6.77	6.79	6.98

S&P Sector Returns



Sources: Bloomberg, Factset. Total Returns from the period of 07/27/2026 to 07/31/2026. [†]Bloomberg Barclays Indices. ^{††}Spot price returns. All data as of the 07/31/2026 close. Data would differ if a different time period was displayed. Short-term performance shown to illustrate more recent trend. **Past performance is no guarantee of future results.**

Economic Forecasts (as of 7/31/2026)

Economic Forecasts	Q1 2026A	Q2 2026A	Q3 2026E	Q4 2026E	2026E	2027E
Real global GDP (% y/y annualized)	-	-	-	-	3.2	3.5
Real U.S. GDP (% q/q annualized)	2.1	1.5	2.5	2.4	2.1	2.2
CPI inflation (% y/y)	2.7	3.8	3.2	2.9	3.2	2.0
Core CPI inflation (% y/y)	2.5	2.7	2.4	2.5	2.5	2.5
Unemployment rate (%)	4.3	4.3	4.3	4.2	4.3	4.2
Fed funds rate, end period (%)	3.63	3.63	3.88	4.38	4.38	4.38

The forecasts in the table above are the base line view from BofA Global Research. The Global Wealth & Investment Management (GWIM) Investment Strategy Committee (ISC) may make adjustments to this view over the course of the year and can express upside/downside to these forecasts. Historical data is sourced from Bloomberg, FactSet, and Haver Analytics. **There can be no assurance that the forecasts will be achieved. Economic or financial forecasts are inherently limited and should not be relied on as indicators of future investment performance.** A = Actual. E/* = Estimate. Data as of July 31, 2026.

Sources: BofA Global Research; GWIM ISC as of July 31, 2026.

Asset Class Weightings (as of 7/7/2026)

Asset Class	CIO View				
	Underweight		Neutral		Overweight
Global Equities	•	•	•	●	•
U.S. Large-cap Growth	•	•	•	●	•
U.S. Large-cap Value	•	•	•	●	•
U.S. Small-cap Growth	•	•	•	●	•
U.S. Small-cap Value	•	•	•	●	•
International Developed	•	●	•	•	•
Emerging Markets	•	•	•	●	•
Global Fixed Income	•	●	•	•	•
U.S. Governments	•	●	•	•	•
U.S. Mortgages	•	●	•	•	•
U.S. Corporates	•	●	•	•	•
International Fixed Income	•	●	•	•	•
High Yield	•	●	•	•	•
U.S. Investment-grade Tax Exempt	•	●	•	•	•
U.S. High Yield Tax Exempt	•	●	•	•	•
Alternative Investments*					
Hedge Strategies					
Private Equity					
Private Credit					
Real Assets					
Cash					

* Many products that pursue Alternative Investment strategies, specifically Private Equity and Hedge Funds, are available only to qualified investors. CIO asset class views are relative to the CIO Strategic Asset Allocation (SAA) of a multi-asset portfolio. Source: Chief Investment Office as of July 7, 2026. All sector and asset allocation recommendations must be considered in the context of an individual investor's goals, time horizon, liquidity needs and risk tolerance. Not all recommendations will be in the best interest of all investors.

CIO Equity Sector Views

Sector	CIO View				
	Underweight		Neutral		Overweight
Industrials	•	•	•	●	•
Consumer Discretionary	•	•	•	●	•
Financials	•	•	•	●	•
Information Technology	•	•	●	•	•
Energy	•	•	●	•	•
Materials	•	•	●	•	•
Utilities	•	•	●	•	•
Healthcare	•	•	●	•	•
Communication Services	•	●	•	•	•
Real Estate	•	●	•	•	•
Consumer Staples	•	●	•	•	•

Index Definitions

Securities indexes assume reinvestment of all distributions and interest payments. Indexes are unmanaged and do not take into account fees or expenses. It is not possible to invest directly in an index. Indexes are all based in U.S. dollars.

S&P 500 Index is a stock market index tracking the stock performance of 500 leading companies listed on stock exchanges in the United States.

MSCI Emerging Markets Index captures large and mid-cap representation across Emerging Markets (EM) countries.

MSCI Europe Index captures large and mid cap representation across Developed Markets (DM) countries in Europe.

MSCI Global Semiconductor Index is composed of large and mid-cap stocks across Developed Markets (DM) countries.

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CHIEF INVESTMENT OFFICE

Capital Market Outlook

July 27, 2026

All data, projections and opinions are as of the date of this report and subject to change.

IN THIS ISSUE

Macro Strategy—Moderate Growth, Anchored Inflation, Resilient Risk Appetite:

Markets have so far treated the Iran war as a temporary oil-supply disturbance. Combined with moderate U.S. growth and tempered inflation expectations, this view limited the increase in bond yields and bond yield volatility despite surging oil prices—a positive for risk-asset performance. The gold-to-copper ratio has reversed its spike spurred by the April 2025 tariff shock and extended through the March 2026 start of the Iran war, consistent with easing growth concerns and a risk-on market tilt. Rising copper prices have confirmed growth support from Artificial Intelligence (AI)-investment and broader electrification efforts, while also reflecting supply factors (high fuel costs; war-related shortages of sulfuric acid used in copper production; mining setbacks; tariffs, and rising China refined-copper imports due to smelter maintenance and other pressures not purely end-demand driven). Overall, the data suggests the economy likely retains a sufficient cushion to absorb the current oil price shock, allowing the expansion to continue at a moderate pace. However, escalating geopolitical conflicts increase growth and inflation risks.

Market View—International Equity Markets: Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Challenges:

Recent weakness in the Technology sector has highlighted a major dividing line across international equity markets, underscoring the importance of the group to relative returns internationally. A key question for investors will therefore be whether the advance in technology-linked markets can continue, particularly within upstream segments related to AI data center investment. Meanwhile, the return of energy supply constraints in the Middle East poses a growing risk to European and Asian markets. Though both were able to withstand the disruptions to production, shipping and prices during the first phase of the Iran conflict, the July re-escalation could potentially be more challenging should it persist over the weeks and months ahead.

Thought of the Week—Behind the Surge in Business Formation: The “Solopreneur”:

U.S. business applications are running north of 6 million over the 12 months through June 2026. In other words, entrepreneurial activity is booming in the U.S. Yet an underappreciated driver of the surge has been the rise of the “solopreneur”—or solo founders running businesses without employees. Since the start of 2025, solopreneur applications have risen by 23%, while “high-propensity” applications (businesses likely to hire) are essentially flat.

What’s driving entrepreneurs to go solo? Enter generative AI, which has lowered barriers to entry and enabled businesses to innovate, produce and expand without hiring. For investors, this is a direct reflection of the U.S. economy’s entrepreneurial DNA and a key reason to keep the U.S. at the center of portfolios. Think more competition, greater innovation and, over time, higher productivity—a potent recipe for corporate earnings and U.S. growth. As AI adoption grows and as the cost of technology declines, we expect new small businesses, the backbone of the U.S. economy, to be among the biggest recipients of productivity gains.

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MACRO STRATEGY ►

MARKET VIEW ►

THOUGHT OF THE WEEK ►

MARKETS IN REVIEW ►

Portfolio Considerations

The “Era of Transformation” is being driven by innovation, capital investment, infrastructure needs, and evolving themes that extend from short-term resilience and earnings growth to longer-term Rebalancing, Re-globalization, Reconstruction, and Rearmament.

Persistent shortages across AI-related resources, infrastructure, minerals, and defense equipment are expected to support productivity, profit margins, asset-price growth, and attractive potential opportunities across global equity markets, despite periodic “Bullwhip” market volatility.

We remain overweight U.S. and Emerging Market Equities—favoring Industrials, Financials and Consumer Discretionary—while maintaining balanced exposure between Growth and Value, and views higher Fixed Income yields as attractive for income, diversification and risk compensation.

Moderate Growth, Anchored Inflation, Resilient Risk Appetite

Chief Investment Office, Macro Strategy Team

Incoming data suggest U.S. growth remains moderate and close to potential rather than overheating. Activity is being pulled in both directions: wealth effects, inflation-indexed government transfers, government spending, tax incentives and the AI investment boom continue to support it—while higher oil prices and tariffs, slower wage growth, cautious bank lending, elevated consumer borrowing costs and soft hiring restrain it.

The Federal Reserve's (Fed) Beige Book prepared for the July 28–29 rate-setting meeting, supports this view. Over the mid-May to early July reference period, 11 of 12 Fed districts reported expansion, the broadest improvement since early 2025. Yet, the expansion was characterized as slight to moderate, with moderate price increases, wage growth modest to moderate, and employment rising on balance but showing little to no change in seven of 12 districts. Recent ADP data also show that four-week average employment gains have started to fade through the July 4 week after picking up earlier this year.

With slower and narrower job creation (private-sector employment outside healthcare and education is still lower than two years ago), labor-market slack has grown. The average duration of unemployment has increased, job openings have declined and the pool of people outside the labor force who nevertheless want a job has expanded. The lack of labor-market dynamism—partly due to a widening mismatch between jobs and skills as the economy changes and technology advances—has also restrained wage growth, constraining consumer spending.

Indeed, although June retail sales surprised to the upside, the underlying signal was less upbeat than the headline suggested. According to BofA Global Research, non-store retailers accounted for much of the strength, helped by special promotions that could partly reverse in July. Spending in most other categories remained tepid, with limited evidence of a meaningful net boost from the World Cup. While upward revisions to prior months, especially to food services, lifted expectations for Q2 real consumer spending after a very weak Q1 gain, real gross domestic product (GDP) still tracks around 1.75% to 2% for Q2, according to various estimates, consistent with moderate, non-inflationary growth outside energy-price effects. In fact, renewed fuel-price pressures, alongside fading support from early-year tax refunds, point to persistent growth headwinds in the second half.

Manufacturing tells a similarly mixed story. After two strong monthly gains earlier in the year, output increased modestly in May and contracted in June (Exhibit 1A). The AI investment boom is leaking into large imports of semiconductors and related equipment, limiting its domestic growth and employment impact relative to headline investment outlays. Also, a strong dollar restrains exports. On the other hand, lean inventories across several industries point to a likely restocking cycle in coming quarters. In addition, defense spending and rebounding aerospace production, alongside favorable regional Fed July surveys point to continued manufacturing-sector expansion. This is consistent with further improvement in the Institute for Supply Management manufacturing index—typically a constructive signal for corporate earnings and investor risk appetite.

Against a backdrop of moderate growth, sharply lower June oil prices and fading tariff effects, inflation delivered an encouraging downside surprise for a change. Not only did June headline consumer price index (CPI) inflation decline sharply alongside lower oil prices, but “core” CPI (excluding food and energy) also posted a small but rare monthly decline, nudging the year-over-year (YoY) rate down to 2.6% from 2.8% in May. The improvement was broad based: prices of goods excluding food and energy declined, prices for services excluding energy and rent of shelter declined, and a larger share of CPI components (about a third) declined. With housing still likely to contribute to future disinflation—as new-lease measures remain soft and multifamily supply continues to expand—and little evidence that tariffs or energy prices are feeding a broader wage-price spiral so far, gradual inflation normalization without much Fed tightening is likely, in our view.

Investment Implications

With moderate U.S. growth and inflation underpinnings, we expect investors to continue to favor economically sensitive sectors and AI-investment beneficiaries, assuming stabilization of geopolitical situation.

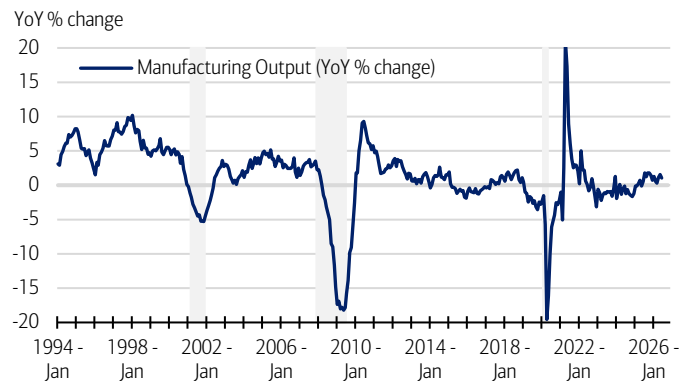
The main risk to the outlook remains energy. Although the global economy has adapted better than expected to Strait of Hormuz disruptions, as discussed in recent reports, renewed and expanded trade barriers raise risks to both growth and inflation. Ukrainian attacks on Russian refining and export infrastructure have further tightened the global refined-products market, with at least 24 of Russia’s 34 large refineries reportedly struck by drones and bringing Russian crude processing down to its lowest level in more than two decades. Given its large export footprint, especially for diesel, Russian diesel and jet fuel export restrictions combined with gasoline imports have tightened refined-product markets. India’s recent introduction of higher fuel export taxes and China’s preference for preserving crude inventories while retaining large underutilized refining capacity reduce the likelihood of near-term supply relief. In fact, the threatened blockade of the Bab-el-Mandeb strait would extend the transit time for roughly three million barrels per day of Saudi oil going to Asia by about a month, with additional logistical complexity tied to Suez Canal tanker capacity constraints also increasing costs and transit time.

According to the EIA, with U.S. refiners running at full capacity, commercial crude inventories remain above pre-2015 levels. However, refiners have prioritized jet fuel and distillate production to meet strong global demand, causing gasoline inventories to fall below their five-year range. Reflecting tight supply, U.S. gasoline and diesel prices have risen to levels consistent with roughly \$140 and \$170 per barrel crude oil, respectively. Moreover, fuel markets remain vulnerable to potential unexpected refinery maintenance requirements. The Strategic Petroleum Reserve (SPR) has declined to 40-year lows and is approaching operational limits.

Still, because of a big decline in the U.S. economy’s energy intensity, diesel and gasoline costs as a share of GDP remain below past oil-shock levels (around 2.2% vs. roughly 4.5% in 1973, for example). Also, the U.S. is now an oil exporter rather than a large oil importer. This suggests that oil prices are not high enough to cause a U.S. or global recession. According to Dallas Fed Research, June 23, 2026, the estimated effect on U.S. GDP growth in 1980 from a similar oil shock as that caused by the Hormuz crisis this year would have had a 20 times larger impact (Exhibit 1B). Global fuel intensity has also declined significantly, but the U.S. resilience is still greater. At current prices, there are still sufficient growth tailwinds to keep the expansion going at a moderate pace. Also positive, tempered growth and still anchored inflation expectations have helped keep the 10-year Treasury yield in its relatively narrow range of the past two years despite spiking oil prices, with markets relatively comfortable with the gradual uptick in yields to date. The bigger risk to asset prices would be a disorderly rise in real yields and bond-market volatility, including if driven by Fed interest rate hikes without stronger growth.

Exhibit 1: Inflation Divergence Likely to Resolve to the Downside.

A) Industrial Production still moderate compared to past economic booms.



B) Tremendously greater resilience to oil shock today compared to the past.

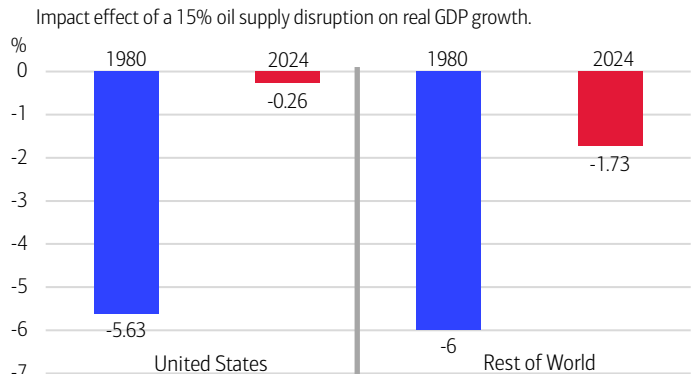


Exhibit 1A) Sources: Federal Reserve Board/Haver Analytics. Data as of July 23, 2026. Exhibit 1B) The oil supply disruption originates in the rest of the world. All values are based on a one-quarter oil supply disruption. The growth rates are annualized percentage point deviations from the pre-shock baseline. Source: Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas. Data as of June 23, 2026.

International Equity Markets—Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Challenges

Ehiwario Efeyini, *Director and Senior Investment Strategist*

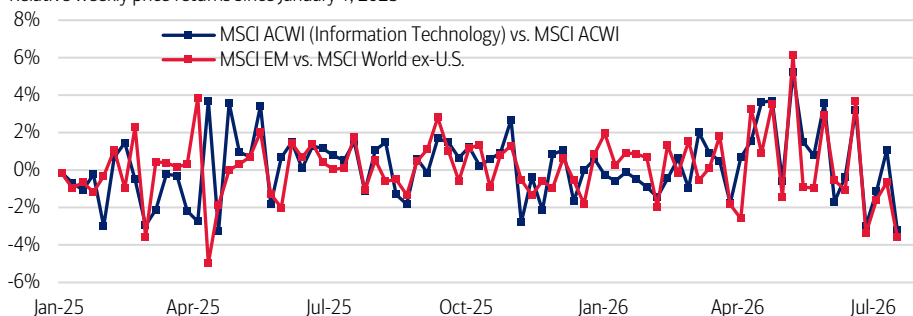
The drawdown in the global Technology sector between early-June and mid-July has highlighted a major dividing line across international equity markets. Europe has been the global leader over the period, emerging Asian markets have been by far the weakest, and the U.S. and Japan have fallen in between the two. This has been a mirror image of the full year 2026 so far, in which technology leadership has driven outperformance in emerging markets and seen Europe lag. And it underscores the current importance of the Technology sector to relative international returns, given the wide disparities now present in regional capitalization weightings. Technology exposure (including the internet platforms listed in Communication Services and Consumer Discretionary) now accounts for 50% of the MSCI Emerging Market (EM) Index benchmark (and 60% of emerging Asia), with the semiconductor industry group alone forming 35% of EM Equities (and 42% of emerging Asia).

By contrast, Europe's Technology sector exposure stands at just 10%. Indeed, since the start of 2025, the MSCI EM Index has outpaced the overall developed ex-U.S. benchmark (MSCI World ex-U.S.) in 70% of the weekly periods in which the global Technology sector has risen by more than global Equities (MSCI All-Country World) in aggregate (Exhibit 2).

Exhibit 2: Emerging Markets have Led Global Equities During Recent Periods of Strength in the Technology Sector.

Global technology relative return vs. emerging markets relative return

Relative weekly price returns since January 1, 2025



Sources: MSCI; Bloomberg. Data as of July 17, 2026. It is not possible to invest directly in an index. Please refer to index definitions at the end of this report. **Past performance is no guarantee of future results.**

A key question for international markets in the second half of the year will therefore be whether the advance in technology-linked markets can continue, particularly within upstream segments related to AI data center investment. And important to watch here will be the capital spending plans of the cloud hyperscalers, pricing power in critical parts of the supply chain such as memory, foundry and semicap equipment, and, ultimately, user demand for models and developer applications. Wider AI adoption and more application use cases would likely allow market participation to extend further downstream within the sector, including in China, whose capitalization share of the MSCI EM index has halved over the past five years, but at close to 20% remains the third-largest after Taiwan and Korea. And notwithstanding the potential for further bouts of volatility of the type experienced over recent weeks, broader gains for the tech sector should continue to favor EMs and Asia over Europe.

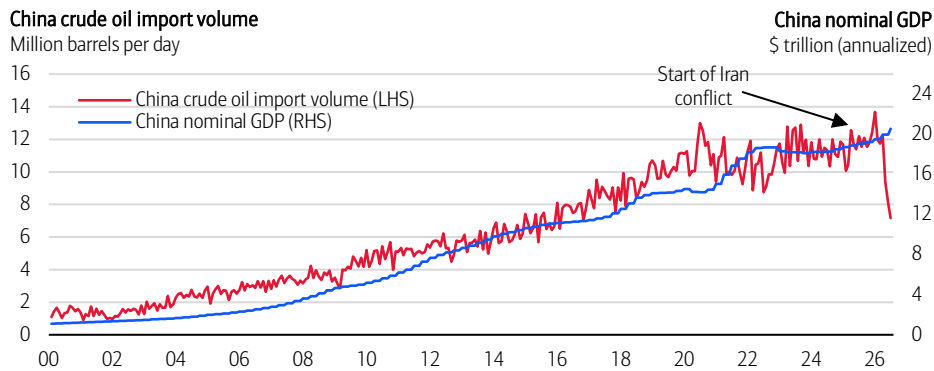
The return of energy supply constraints in the Middle East nonetheless poses a growing risk to both European and Asian markets. Both are heavily reliant on imported oil and gas in their primary energy consumption, with Asia more directly dependent on shipments from the Middle East. And though both markets were able to withstand the disruptions to production, shipping and prices during the first phase of the Iran conflict, the July re-escalation could potentially be more challenging should it persist over the weeks and months ahead.

Investment Implications

We maintain a favorable view on EMs relative to Europe, but continue to weigh the potential impact of changes to the macro environment related to the pivotal themes of technology and energy. We also stay cautious on the UK market, particularly in light of this month's change in central government leadership. And we remain constructive on Japan, despite the market facing similar risks to much of emerging Asia from any further tightening in global energy supply.

The MSCI Europe and MSCI emerging Asia benchmarks corrected by 10% to 15% in March following the initial outbreak of the conflict but rebounded in Q2 even in the face of higher energy prices as activity in the sector adjusted. Individual countries were able to draw upon their national oil inventories. China in particular (by far the largest global energy importer) reduced its oil imports by around 40%, taking them back to 2016 levels when its economy was roughly half its current size (Exhibit 3). And oil and gas export volumes were redirected to Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast.

Exhibit 3: China's Oil Import Volumes have Fallen Sharply Since the Start of the Iran Conflict.



Sources: Bloomberg; Chief Investment Office. Data as of June 2026. Import volume converted from tons to barrels at ratio of 7.33:1

But these three sources of relief are unlikely to offer the same cushion for markets in the current phase of the conflict. Global observed oil inventories have now been drawn down by more than 300 million barrels over the period between March and June, according to the International Energy Agency. Depending on its willingness to further deplete its domestic stockpiles, China's oil import demand could begin to increase again from depressed levels. And risks to energy exports through the Red Sea could force a diversion of the estimated 5.4 million barrels per day of oil and 2.9 billion cubic feet per day of liquefied natural gas that were transported through the waterway in Q1 of 2026, according to the U.S. Energy Information Administration. It also remains to be seen how global monetary authorities will react to higher headline inflation driven by the recent energy price surge. Higher interest rates could present an additional hurdle for international equity markets if central banks are forced to tighten policy. We maintain a favorable view on EMs relative to Europe, but continue to weigh the potential impact of changes to the macro environment related to these two pivotal themes of technology and energy.

Our view on the smaller regional developed markets also remains intact and has been reinforced by recent local developments. As in continental Europe, we stay cautious on the U.K. market, particularly in light of this month's change in central government leadership. Even though the ruling party remains in place and its platform is officially unchanged, the new prime minister is expected to pursue a more redistributionist policy agenda and has suggested introducing more flexibility into national budget rules with the potential for future increases in tax rates. The fiscal outlook will therefore be important to watch over the coming months for any potential deterioration in investor perceptions around the local market. And, at the same time, we remain constructive on Japan. Given its dependence on imported oil from the Middle East, the Japan market faces similar risks to much of emerging Asia from any further tightening in global energy supply from the region. And to a lesser extent, it should also remain sensitive to volatility in the Technology sector, given its hardware exposure to industry groups such as semicap equipment and electronic components. We nonetheless still see structural supports from shareholder-friendly deployment of corporate cash for buybacks, payouts and acquisitions, in addition to fiscal expansion coming from the new administration, and both competitive support and a translation boost on overseas profits from yen weakness.

Behind the Surge in U.S. Business Formation: The “Solopreneur”

Ariana Chiu, Assistant Vice President and Investment Strategist

Business formation is at all-time highs in the U.S., with applications over the 12 months through June 2026 running north of 6 million.¹ In other words, entrepreneurial activity is booming in the U.S. But an underappreciated feature of the recent surge in business applications has been the rise of the “solopreneur”—or solo founders who run businesses on their own without employees.

As Exhibit 4A highlights, the increase in business applications since the start of 2025 has been primarily driven by solopreneurs. Whereas their applications have risen by 23% in just the last year and a half, applications among “high-propensity” businesses (i.e., businesses likely to hire workers) are essentially flat over the same period. Translated: Solo founders have fueled most of the recent acceleration in business creation. Data from Stripe, a financial services platform, confirms in Exhibit 4B: The wave of new startups, particularly in Q1 of this year, has largely been the work of solo founders.

What’s driving entrepreneurs to go solo? Enter generative artificial intelligence (AI), which has lowered barriers to entry and enabled businesses to innovate, produce, market and expand, all without necessarily hiring additional employees. Indeed, the sectors that have seen the largest growth in business applications such as Information and Professional Services are also the sectors with the highest AI adoption rates of 44% and 38% respectively.¹ All the while, job growth in these sectors has been limited or negative. Employment in the Information sector, for example, is currently below pre-pandemic levels—despite the sector’s gross domestic product expanding by over 50% since the start of the decade.

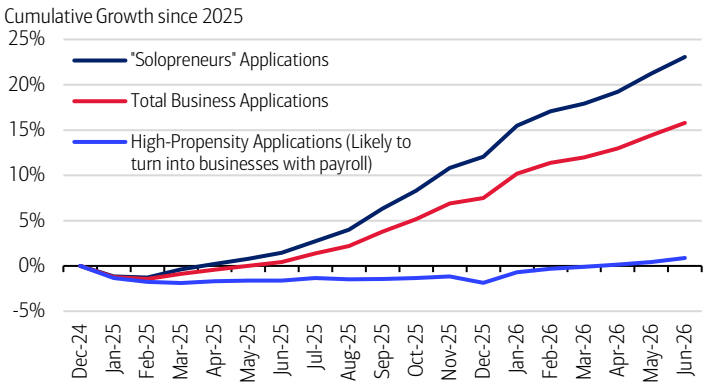
For investors, the rise of the solopreneur and the attendant increase in business formation is a direct reflection of the U.S. economy’s entrepreneurial DNA. We believe that’s a key reason to maintain the U.S. at the center of portfolios because it means more competition, greater innovation and, over time, higher productivity—all of which are good news for corporate earnings and U.S. growth. Already, AI has helped lift company margins with earnings as a share of GDP at a record 14% as of Q1 2026.² As AI adoption grows and as the cost of technology declines, we expect new small businesses, the backbone of the U.S. economy, to be among the biggest recipients of productivity gains.

Investment Implications

Recent trends in business applications reinforce our conviction in America’s risk-taking entrepreneurial culture. AI adoption should continue to help profits expand more broadly across sectors. Stay overweight the U.S. in portfolios.

Exhibit 4: The Rise of the Solopreneur.

A) Breaking down higher business applications.



B) Startups go solo.

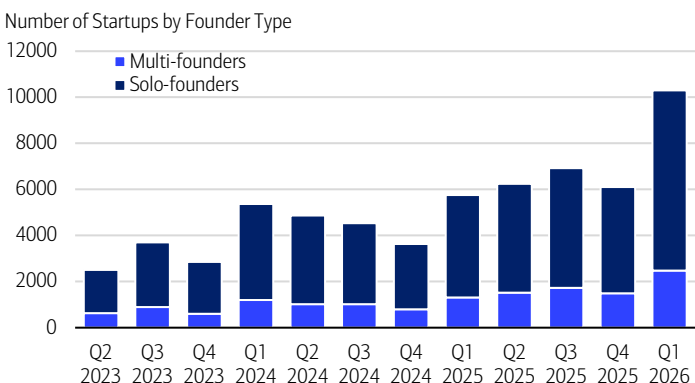


Exhibit 4A) “Solopreneurs” refers to non-high-propensity applications. Source: Census Bureau. Data as of July 9, 2026. Exhibit 4B) Source: Stripe. Data through Q1 2026, as of July 2026.

¹ Census Bureau. Data as of July 2026.

² Bureau of Economic Analysis. Data as of July 2026.

Equities

Equities	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	WTD	MTD	YTD
DJIA	51,947.25	-0.4	-0.6	9.0
NASDAQ	24,975.82	-2.1	-4.7	7.8
S&P 500	7,411.98	-0.6	-1.1	9.0
S&P 400 Mid Cap	3,783.86	0.2	-1.7	15.3
Russell 2000	2,930.00	-1.1	-3.1	18.8
MSCI World	4,788.90	-0.4	-0.7	8.9
MSCI EAFE	3,113.50	0.4	-0.1	9.4
MSCI Emerging Markets	1,628.03	0.5	-5.3	17.3

Fixed Income[†]

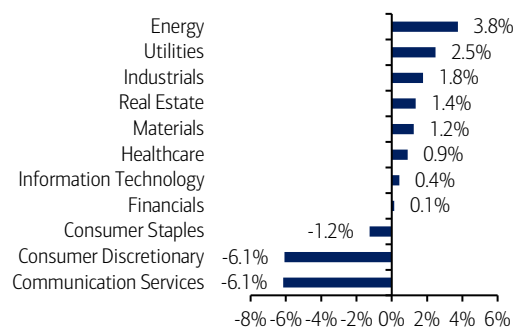
Fixed Income	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	WTD	MTD	YTD
Corporate & Government	4.88	-0.73	-1.20	-0.72
Agencies	4.63	-0.39	-0.45	0.16
Municipals	3.94	-1.19	-1.98	0.30
U.S. Investment-Grade Credit	4.97	-0.74	-1.18	-0.57
International	5.47	-0.92	-1.61	-0.77
High Yield	7.46	-0.57	-0.43	1.52
90 Day Yield	3.90	3.79	3.81	3.63
2 Year Yield	4.33	4.18	4.17	3.47
10 Year Yield	4.68	4.55	4.47	4.17
30 Year Yield	5.16	5.07	4.95	4.84

Commodities & Currencies

Commodities	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	WTD	MTD	YTD
Bloomberg Commodity	346.90	2.8	9.8	25.6
WTI Crude \$/Barrel ^{††}	89.31	8.3	28.5	55.5
Gold Spot \$/Ounce ^{††}	4052.79	0.9	1.1	-6.2

Currencies	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	Prior Week End	Prior Month End	2025 Year End
EUR/USD	1.14	1.14	1.14	1.17
USD/JPY	163.83	162.40	162.55	156.71
USD/CNH	6.77	6.78	6.79	6.98

S&P Sector Returns



Sources: Bloomberg, Factset. Total Returns from the period of 07/20/2026 to 07/24/2026. [†]Bloomberg Barclays Indices. ^{††}Spot price returns. All data as of the 07/24/2026 close. Data would differ if a different time period was displayed. Short-term performance shown to illustrate more recent trend. **Past performance is no guarantee of future results.**

Economic Forecasts (as of 7/24/2026)

Economic Forecasts	Q1 2026A	Q2 2026A	Q3 2026E	Q4 2026E	2026E	2027E
Real global GDP (% y/y annualized)	-	-	-	-	3.2	3.5
Real U.S. GDP (% q/q annualized)	2.1	2.5*	2.5	2.4	2.3	2.2
CPI inflation (% y/y)	2.7	3.8	3.4	3.1	3.3	2.1
Core CPI inflation (% y/y)	2.5	2.7	2.4	2.5	2.5	2.5
Unemployment rate (%)	4.3	4.3	4.3	4.2	4.3	4.2
Fed funds rate, end period (%)	3.63	3.63	3.88	4.38	4.38	4.38

The forecasts in the table above are the base line view from BofA Global Research. The Global Wealth & Investment Management (GWIM) Investment Strategy Committee (ISC) may make adjustments to this view over the course of the year and can express upside/downside to these forecasts. Historical data is sourced from Bloomberg, FactSet, and Haver Analytics. **There can be no assurance that the forecasts will be achieved. Economic or financial forecasts are inherently limited and should not be relied on as indicators of future investment performance.** A = Actual. E/* = Estimate. Data as of July 24, 2026. Sources: BofA Global Research; GWIM ISC as of July 24, 2026.

Asset Class Weightings (as of 7/7/2026)

Asset Class	CIO View				
	Underweight		Neutral		Overweight
Global Equities	•	•	•	●	•
U.S. Large-cap Growth	•	•	•	●	•
U.S. Large-cap Value	•	•	•	●	•
U.S. Small-cap Growth	•	•	•	●	•
U.S. Small-cap Value	•	•	•	●	•
International Developed	•	●	•	•	•
Emerging Markets	•	•	•	●	•
Global Fixed Income	•	●	•	•	•
U.S. Governments	•	●	•	•	•
U.S. Mortgages	•	●	•	•	•
U.S. Corporates	•	●	•	•	•
International Fixed Income	•	●	•	•	•
High Yield	•	●	•	•	•
U.S. Investment-grade Tax Exempt	•	●	•	•	•
U.S. High Yield Tax Exempt	•	●	•	•	•
Alternative Investments*					
Hedge Strategies					
Private Equity					
Private Credit					
Real Assets					
Cash					

* Many products that pursue Alternative Investment strategies, specifically Private Equity and Hedge Funds, are available only to qualified investors. CIO asset class views are relative to the CIO Strategic Asset Allocation (SAA) of a multi-asset portfolio. Source: Chief Investment Office as of July 7, 2026. All sector and asset allocation recommendations must be considered in the context of an individual investor's goals, time horizon, liquidity needs and risk tolerance. Not all recommendations will be in the best interest of all investors.

CIO Equity Sector Views

Sector	CIO View				
	Underweight		Neutral		Overweight
Industrials	•	•	•	●	•
Consumer Discretionary	•	•	•	●	•
Financials	•	•	•	●	•
Information Technology	•	•	●	•	•
Energy	•	•	●	•	•
Materials	•	•	●	•	•
Utilities	•	•	●	•	•
Healthcare	•	•	●	•	•
Communication Services	•	●	•	•	•
Real Estate	•	●	•	•	•
Consumer Staples	•	●	•	•	•

Index Definitions

Securities indexes assume reinvestment of all distributions and interest payments. Indexes are unmanaged and do not take into account fees or expenses. It is not possible to invest directly in an index. Indexes are all based in U.S. dollars.

S&P 500 Index is a stock market index tracking the stock performance of 500 leading companies listed on stock exchanges in the United States.

MSCI All-Country World Index is a premier benchmark representing global equity performance, covering large and mid-cap stocks across 23 developed and 24 emerging markets.

Institute for Supply Management Manufacturing Index is a composite measure equally weighing new orders, production, employment, supplier deliveries, and inventories.

MSCI Emerging Market Index is a stock market index designed to measure the equity market performance of developing economies globally.

MSCI World ex US Index captures large and mid cap representation across 22 of 23 Developed Markets (DM) countries--excluding the United States.

MSCI Europe Index captures large and mid cap representation across Developed Markets (DM) countries in Europe.

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Investing involves risk, including the possible loss of principal. Past performance is no guarantee of future results.

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Investments have varying degrees of risk. Some of the risks involved with equity securities include the possibility that the value of the stocks may fluctuate in response to events specific to the companies or markets, as well as economic, political or social events in the U.S. or abroad. Small cap and mid cap companies pose special risks, including possible illiquidity and greater price volatility than funds consisting of larger, more established companies. Investing in fixed-income securities may involve certain risks, including the credit quality of individual issuers, possible prepayments, market or economic developments and yields and share price fluctuations due to changes in interest rates. When interest rates go up, bond prices typically drop, and vice versa. Investments in high-yield bonds (sometimes referred to as "junk bonds") offer the potential for high current income and attractive total return, but involves certain risks. Changes in economic conditions or other circumstances may adversely affect a junk bond issuer's ability to make principal and interest payments. Income from investing in municipal bonds is generally exempt from Federal and state taxes for residents of the issuing state. While the interest income is tax-exempt, any capital gains distributed are taxable to the investor. Income for some investors may be subject to the Federal Alternative Minimum Tax (AMT). Treasury bills are less volatile than longer-term fixed income securities and are guaranteed as to timely payment of principal and interest by the U.S. government. Bonds are subject to interest rate, inflation and credit risks. Investments in foreign securities (including ADRs) involve special risks, including foreign currency risk and the possibility of substantial volatility due to adverse political, economic or other developments. These risks are magnified for investments made in emerging markets. Investments in a certain industry or sector may pose additional risk due to lack of diversification and sector concentration. There are special risks associated with an investment in commodities, such as gold, including market price fluctuations, regulatory changes, interest rate changes, credit risk, economic changes and the impact of adverse political or financial factors.

Alternative investments are speculative and involve a high degree of risk.

Alternative investments are intended for qualified investors only. Alternative Investments such as derivatives, hedge funds, private credit, private equity funds, and funds of funds can result in higher return potential but also higher loss potential. Changes in economic conditions or other circumstances may adversely affect your investments. Before you invest in alternative investments, you should consider your overall financial situation, how much money you have to invest, your need for liquidity, and your tolerance for risk.

Nonfinancial assets, such as closely held businesses, real estate, fine art, oil, gas and mineral properties, and timber, farm and ranch land, are complex in nature and involve risks including total loss of value. Special risk considerations include natural events (for example, earthquakes or fires), complex tax considerations, and lack of liquidity. Nonfinancial assets are not in the best interest of all investors. Always consult with your independent attorney, tax advisor, investment manager, and insurance agent for final recommendations and before changing or implementing any financial, tax, or estate planning strategy.

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CHIEF INVESTMENT OFFICE

Capital Market Outlook

July 20, 2026

All data, projections and opinions are as of the date of this report and subject to change.

IN THIS ISSUE

Macro Strategy—Warsh Quashes the Debasement Trade: The debasement trade was a popular narrative in 2025 that described an investment strategy where investors flee fiat currencies and bonds to move into "hard" assets like precious metals and bitcoin. During the search for a new Federal Reserve (Fed) chairman, the debasement narrative was pushed by the financial media, and the independence of the Fed was being called into question given certain candidates. Instead, the appointment of Kevin Warsh has had the opposite effect. For example, precious metals prices have fallen from their debasement peaks as has bitcoin, while the U.S. dollar's foreign exchange value remains strong. Concerns of excessive money printing to fund mounting government debt have been assuaged by the new chairman's focus on fixing the Fed's operations, including those that have caused five straight years of inflation overshoot and the affordability crisis. The confidence that has emerged about Mr. Warsh's commitment to restoring price stability has been reinforced by his choices to lead the five task forces advancing monetary policy. The people chosen to lead the task force on "inflation frameworks" are going to "revisit how the Fed understands and responds to the drivers of inflation."

Market View—The Rotation Test: Signs of broader market leadership have emerged across U.S. Equities in recent weeks. Since the start of June, the equal-weighted S&P 500 Index has outperformed its market-cap weighted counterpart, with leadership expanding beyond Technology. The key question now is not whether market breadth has improved, but whether it can finally be sustained. Investors have seen similar rotation attempts throughout this cycle, only to watch leadership narrow once again as inflation concerns and rate volatility returned to the forefront. That makes the current rotation an important test for the market. Is the market finally beginning to trade on earnings and economic growth, or will inflation and Fed policy expectations continue to dominate market dynamics? Broadening earnings growth and a resilient economic backdrop suggest the current rotation has a stronger fundamental foundation, though its durability remains closely tied to the inflation outlook.

The Ticker Tape—Top Questions Answered Directly by Our Chief Investment Officer (CIO).

- What is our view regarding the prospects for the return on the massive Artificial Intelligence (AI) capital investment? Is all of this worth it?

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MACRO STRATEGY ►

MARKET VIEW ►

THE TICKER TAPE ►

MARKETS IN REVIEW ►

Portfolio Considerations

The "Era of Transformation" is being driven by innovation, capital investment, infrastructure needs, and evolving themes that extend from short-term resilience and earnings growth to longer-term Rebalancing, Re-globalization, Reconstruction, and Rearmament.

Persistent shortages across AI-related resources, infrastructure, minerals, and defense equipment are expected to support productivity, profit margins, asset-price growth, and attractive potential opportunities across global equity markets, despite periodic "Bullwhip" market volatility.

We remain overweight U.S. and Emerging Market Equities—favoring Industrials, Financials, and Consumer Discretionary—while maintaining balanced exposure between Growth and Value, and views higher Fixed Income yields as attractive for income, diversification, and risk compensation.

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Please see last page for important disclosure information.

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Warsh Quashes the Debasement Trade

Chief Investment Office, *Macro Strategy Team*

Money Matters in the Warsh Framework. The three leaders of the "Inflation Frameworks" task force are Greg Mankiw, professor of economics at Harvard University and former chairman, Council of Economic Advisors; Thomas Sargent, professor of economics at New York University and Nobel laureate; and William White, senior fellow at the C.D. Howe Institute and former economic advisor at the Bank for International Settlements (BIS). A brief look at their work and views over long and distinguished careers provides some insight into how they align with Mr. Warsh and his critique of the Fed over recent years.

Professor Mankiw, for example, lays out his views in a paper titled "Six Beliefs I Have About Inflation," (Harvard University, May 18, 2024). The first four beliefs revolve around the Phillips Curve as a good theoretical idea and why it does not work in practice. This is significant because it basically says by extension that the framework the Fed currently uses does not work. Beliefs number five and six are more interesting and dovetail with Warsh's views about what does work.

This leads to belief #5: "The monetary aggregates deserve more attention." Discussing the Fed's big inflation mistake after the pandemic, he says: "The first economist I know of who predicted an inflation surge of this magnitude was Jeremy Siegel. I saw him interviewed on CNBC on May 14, 2021. At the time I was worried about inflation as well, ...But I never thought inflation would rise as much as it did. Siegel, it seemed to me, was being an alarmist, but he turned out to be right. He made his prediction by looking at M2¹ which in 2021 had expanded at a rate not seen since the standard time series began in 1960." Mankiw goes on to say the arguments against considering the monetary aggregates don't hold water and he debunks them. Not coincidentally, M2 recently reappeared in a Fed description of the economy. For the first time, the semi-annual Monetary Policy Report released in July, the first under the Warsh chairmanship, includes a discussion of the M2 monetary aggregate in its evaluation of financial conditions.

The last time the Fed paid much attention to the money supply was during Paul Volcker's tenure in the early 1980s. To bring inflation down from the double-digit levels of the late 1970s, he set lower targets for money supply growth and adjusted interest rates to achieve them. Thus began the long disinflation trend that ended with the pandemic.

Professor Mankiw's Belief #6 about inflation has also made its way to the new Fed, having been discussed by Mr. Warsh at his June post-Federal Open Market Committee press conference: "A target of 2 for inflation is better than a target of 2.0." There is an old joke about economists: They express their sense of humor by putting decimal points on their forecasts. This gives an absurd sense of precision that their analysis and common sense cannot justify. Mr. Warsh made this exact point during his press conference, and it's another sign that the task force work will be the basis for policy at the new Warsh Fed. The implication is policy will focus on keeping inflation in a range around 2%, perhaps 1% to 3%. This would help it average about 2% over time. Recent Fed policy has stopped inflation from falling below 2%. For example, the Fed began easing after its last tightening campaign before inflation even got down to 2%. To average 2% inflation has to run below that sometimes to offset the times when it's above target. The Fed has not done that during the past five years, causing inflation to run persistently above 2%.

Fiscal Dominance Causes Debasement. The source of currency debasement is the inflation that results when the fiscal authority is able to take control of the money printing. History is replete with examples that prove this fact. This is the reason why the Fed was created with a certain amount of independence from political control. Despite this independence, Fed monetary policy has become less independent from

Investment Implications

Bringing inflation down to target and committing to a framework that explicitly controls inflation, much as Paul Volcker did in the 1980s, would likely end the five-year bear market in long-term Treasury bonds and also make financial sector stocks like banks more attractive for the long run.

¹ M2 measure works by conceptually leveraging or deleveraging a fund's portfolio to match the risk level of a reference benchmark, typically a broad market index.

the risk of fiscal dominance since the Great Financial Crisis (GFC) 2007-2008. Policies adopted at that time to reduce the threat of a worse recession have reduced the Fed's separation from fiscal influence. As a Federal Reserve Board member at the time, who was instrumental helping then Chairman Ben Bernanke navigate the financial crisis, Kevin Warsh reportedly disagreed with the policy shifts and resigned. His reforms are aimed at reducing the threat of fiscal dominance.

This is where the Nobel laureate, Thomas Sargent comes into the picture. His selection with Christopher Sims, in 2011 for the Nobel Prize was based on their "empirical research on cause and effect in the macro economy." Some of their early work validated the role of the money supply as the cause of inflation and influenced the Volcker Fed's operations to bring down inflation in the 1980s. Over an illustrious academic career, he has focused on the interplay between fiscal and monetary policy and how that interplay varies depending on true independence versus different degrees of cooperation between the two authorities.

A recent paper² with George J. Hall illustrates his approach to these issues. The paper begins its analysis with a quote from Milton Friedman's 1959 book *A Program For Monetary Stability*: *The fiction that the Federal Reserve System is only quasi-governmental and its separation from the departmental organization of the Federal Administration no doubt alter the impact of political influences and lead to different actions than would be taken if the Reserve System were administratively consolidated with the Treasury. As an economic matter, however, the accounts of the Federal Reserve and the Treasury must be consolidated to determine what monetary action government is taking or to judge what the effects of such action are likely to be.*

Fed officials have adamantly avoided discussing any role fiscal policy may have in their policies, yet the quote above makes it clear that the effects of any given monetary policy depend on what's happening with fiscal policy and the Treasury's accounts. The Fed's pandemic response is a clear example. By ignoring its impact on the money supply, Fed officials were blindsided by the inflation outbreak. As Professor Mankiw noted in the earlier quote, only monetarists saw that outbreak coming, but the Fed had purged monetarism from its thought process.

Warsh has picked Thomas Sargent to help bring monetarist insights back into the Fed's understanding of how inflation works. His focus on the interplay between monetary and fiscal action will fill in some of the holes in the current framework, which needs fixing according to the new boss. The necessity of looking at the Treasury and Fed accounts together to judge effects of monetary policy means that the Task Force on Balance Sheet Policy will be looking at "the institutional implications of the Fed's current balance sheet regime." The Fed has generally regarded the balance sheet as a technical tool to adjust financial market plumbing rather than something that should be fully integrated into the Fed's regular monetary policy, as was made clear for example in recent statements by the Chicago Fed president. In Sargent and Friedman's view, it needs to be integrated into a fully effective inflation framework. The balance sheet policy since the GFC has been part of the "mission creep" that has raised the risk of fiscal dominance. Shrinking it will likely hurt the debasement trade as the markets seem to be realizing. The leaders of the Balance Sheet Task force are chosen to fix these issues.

The third member of the Inflation Task Force, William White, is recognized for his early prediction, while at the BIS, of the crisis that caused the GFC. He is a long-time critic of the easy-money, low-interest rate policies that have created rising cumulative levels of debt through successive cycles. He also blames much of the rise in economic inequality on these policies. As the person who oversaw the preparation of the BIS Annual Report for over a decade, he brings a vast knowledge of the nitty gritty of global financial balance sheets and crises to helping develop a better less risky operating framework to control inflation in the U.S. In our view the task forces are going to create a fundamental structural shift in monetary policy that will reduce inflation and mitigate the affordability issues plaguing American households.

² "Fiscal Consequences of the U.S. War on COVID," August 31, 2025.

The Rotation Test

Kirsten Cabacungan, Vice President and Senior Investment Strategist

Signs of broader market leadership have emerged across U.S. Equities in recent weeks, raising the possibility that the market may finally be broadening beyond a narrow group of AI leaders. Since the start of June, the equal-weight S&P 500 has outperformed its market-cap weighted counterpart, with leadership expanding beyond Technology and into sectors that lagged earlier this year, including Financials and Healthcare. Beneath the surface, participation has improved as well. More than 60% of S&P 500 constituents have outperformed the index since the start of June, while breadth on down days has strengthened considerably. A majority of S&P 500 stocks have finished higher on 11 of the index's last 16 down days since June, or roughly 69% of the time, compared with just 37% of down days over the prior year.

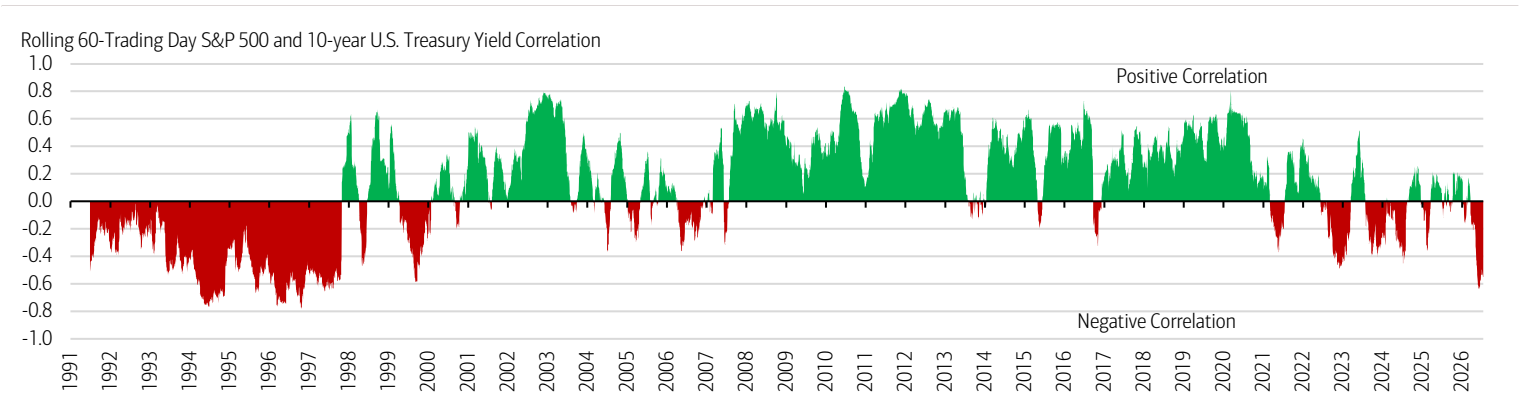
The key question now is not whether market breadth has improved, but whether it can finally be sustained. Investors have seen similar rotation attempts throughout this cycle, only to watch leadership narrow once again as inflation concerns and rate volatility returned to the forefront. That makes the current rotation an important test for the market. Is the market finally beginning to trade on earnings and economic growth, or will inflation and Fed policy expectations continue to dominate market dynamics?

The challenge for the rotation trade is that investors have spent this cycle trading inflation rather than growth. The AI boom has driven much of this bull market's returns and helped concentrate leadership among a relatively small group of mega-cap Technology stocks. However, while AI helps explain why leadership became concentrated, it does not fully explain why that concentration proved so difficult to break. Since 2022, inflation has remained stubbornly above the Fed's 2% target, causing investors to view stronger economic data more through the lens of monetary policy rather than earnings growth. As a result, the relationship between stocks and bond yields has shifted meaningfully. The three-month rolling correlation between the S&P 500 and the 10-year U.S. Treasury yield has turned firmly negative (Exhibit 1), a sharp departure from much of the previous two decades, when higher yields often reflected stronger growth expectations and could coexist with Equity gains. In today's environment, rising yields have more often been interpreted as a signal of persistent inflation and tighter financial conditions, creating a headwind for broader market participation. Put differently, broader market leadership has typically emerged when inflation and rate pressures have eased. That dynamic helps explain why rotation trades have struggled to gain lasting momentum during this cycle.

Investment Implications

One of the most important developments of Q2 was the broadening of market leadership, which suggests potential opportunities are increasingly extending beyond the largest AI beneficiaries. We therefore favor diversified exposure across size, style and sectors, including cyclical areas positioned to benefit from improving manufacturing activity, infrastructure investment and a resilient consumer. We continue to emphasize a high degree of diversification during this stage of the cycle.

Exhibit 1: The Relationship Between Stocks and Bond Yields has Flipped Negative.



Source: Bloomberg. Data as of May 27, 2026. It is not possible to invest directly in an index. Please refer to index definitions at the end of this report. **Past performance is no guarantee of future results.**

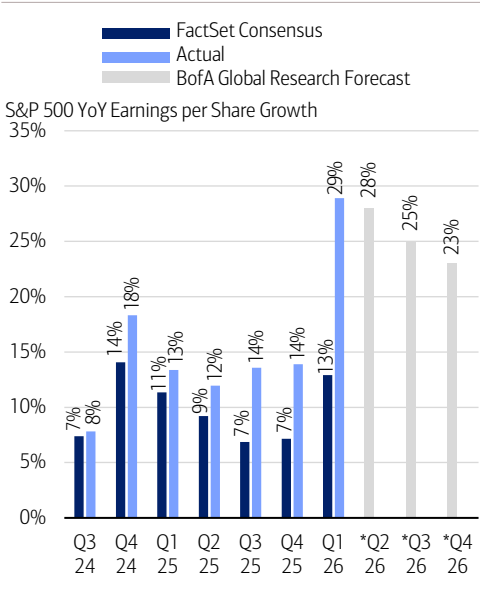
Recent market broadening appears to reflect a subtle but important shift in investor behavior. As geopolitical risks surrounding the U.S./Iran conflict appeared to subside and oil prices retreated in June, investors became increasingly willing to look beyond a narrow and crowded group of AI leaders following their powerful rally since the March lows. Importantly, the rotation reflected a market rebalancing rather than a broad risk-off capitulation, with investors still embracing the AI theme while increasingly broadening exposure to other areas of the market across sectors, styles and sizes. Financials and Healthcare emerged as early beneficiaries, while Small-caps and Value-oriented stocks also attracted renewed investor interest. The recent broadening has been encouraging, but it remains highly dependent on the inflation backdrop. Renewed military tensions in the Middle East serve as a reminder that inflation concerns have not fully disappeared and could once again challenge broader market participation.

The good news is that fundamental conditions are increasingly supportive of broader market leadership. Historically, sustained periods of market broadening have required earnings growth breadth, and there are growing signs that condition is falling into place. Earnings estimates show no signs of earnings momentum rolling over. BofA Global Research forecasts Q2 S&P 500 earnings per share (EPS) growth of 28% year-on-year (YoY) and have raised their full-year 2026 estimate to 26%. If realized, Q2 would mark a seventh consecutive quarter of double-digit YoY earnings growth and the second straight quarter above 20% (Exhibit 2). While the bulk of Q2 earnings growth is expected to be driven by Tech and Energy, the more important signal is that earnings growth looks more broad-based. FactSet estimates show 10 of 11 S&P 500 sectors are expected to post positive YoY growth in Q2 and all sectors are expected to deliver positive growth for the full year.

Broadening earnings growth is being reinforced by a resilient economic backdrop. The Institute for Supply Management Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI) has remained in expansion territory, increasing 9% YoY on average in Q2, while the ISM Services PMI rose 6% YoY on average during the quarter (Exhibit 3). Historically, these trends have been consistent with continued earnings growth, with the Manufacturing PMI trend implying roughly 10% EPS growth in Q2 while Services PMI implies closer to 20% growth, according to BofA Global Research. While those historical relationships imply earnings growth below current consensus expectations, they likely understate the contribution from Technology in the current cycle. More importantly, improving manufacturing and services activity suggests the growth backdrop remains supportive of the areas of the market that have recently benefited from broader participation. Together with improving earnings breadth, that provides a strong fundamental foundation for broader market leadership.

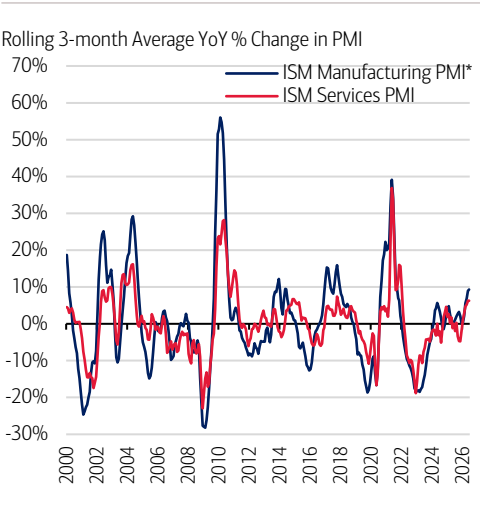
The bottom line for investors is not to abandon the AI trade but to broaden exposure beyond it. As the macroeconomic backdrop remains resilient and earnings growth broadens, diversification across sectors, styles and market capitalizations becomes increasingly important. Still, this remains an inflation-driven cycle. The durability of the current rotation will depend in large part on whether inflation pressures remain contained and how policymakers respond. The evolution of the conflict in the Middle East and its implications for energy prices therefore remain important to monitor. For now, however, broader earnings participation and improving economic activity suggest that market leadership may finally have a stronger foundation than at other points during this cycle.

Exhibit 2: Earnings Growth Remains Resilient.



*Estimates. BofA Global Research; FactSet. Data as of July 16, 2026.

Exhibit 3: Economic Activity Is Expanding.



*Institute for Supply Management Purchasing Managers' Index. Source: Bloomberg. Data as of July 16, 2026. Please refer to index definitions at the end of this report.

What is our view regarding the prospects for the return on the massive AI capital investment? Is all of this worth it?

Christopher Hyzy, Chief Investment Officer

Much of the focus on the actual return on investment (ROI) has been squarely on the consumer side of the buildout, not on the full picture. The consumer side of this equation only looks at traditional spending similar to the initial movement in software many years ago. The focus is on the cost per user over a set timeframe—number of subscribers multiplied by the cost per subscription. There will likely be some components of this as a core element of accumulating revenues if you are a large language model owner or a hyperscaler in general. However, in our view, this is likely only a sliver of the overall return.

The "real" return is wider and deeper. It involves examining corporate profit margins across industry groups in public and private companies of all sizes. If margins are expanding, profitability rising and economic growth increasing collectively, the ROI is inherent in the overall growth in the pool of capital globally. In other words, the payback is higher growth, greater profitability, wider margins and increasing productivity. The ROI is not on the nominal spend by consumers and corporations that are individual users of AI—it is whether or not the level of economic growth over time is much higher. Does this create a flywheel or a pendulum?

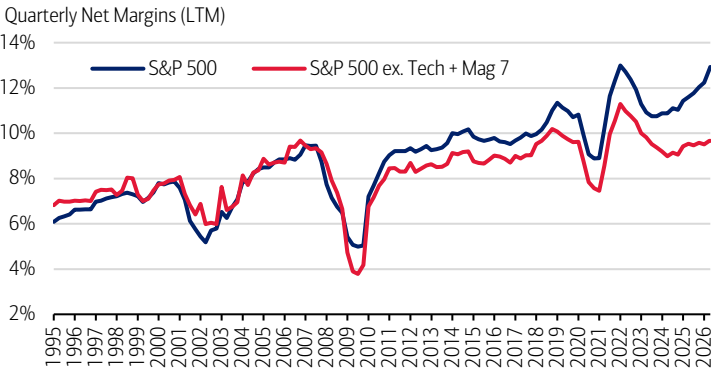
We say flywheel. When the railroads were first built and tracks were laid, the capital investment was extensive and took years. The payback wasn't the cost of a passenger ticket—it was the overall level of commerce of goods and services that was created. Not to mention the growth of new cities, new industries and ultimately new jobs.

Investment Implications

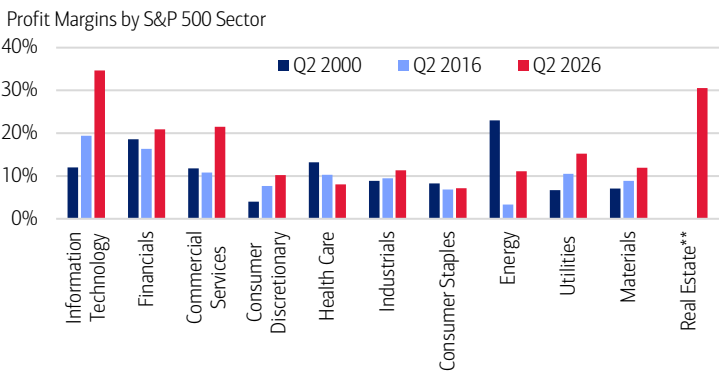
AI-driven shortages across Compute, Light, Architecture, Memory, Power and Stacks (CLAMPS), along with key resources and infrastructure, are expected to support higher productivity, sustained profit margins, broad Equity potential opportunities, asset reflation, and relatively stable interest rates.

Exhibit 4: Margin Resiliency Across Industries.

A) Excluding Technology and Magnificent 7*, S&P 500 Margins Continue to Expand.



B) Seven Sectors Exhibiting Higher Profit Margins Compared to 10 years ago.



*Magnificent 7=Apple, Amazon, Alphabet, Nvidia, Meta, Microsoft, and Tesla. Exhibit 4A) Source: FactSet. Data as of July 16, 2026. It is not possible to invest directly in an index. Please refer to index definitions at the end of this report. **Past performance is no guarantee of future results.** Exhibit 4B) Source: Bloomberg. Data as of June 30, 2026. **Real Estate data available from September 2016 to June 2026.

MARKETS IN REVIEW

Equities

	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	WTD	MTD	YTD
Equities				
DJIA	52,146.42	-0.9	-0.3	9.4
NASDAQ	25,520.24	-2.9	-2.6	10.2
S&P 500	7,457.69	-1.5	-0.5	9.6
S&P 400 Mid Cap	3,775.17	-0.1	-2.0	15.0
Russell 2000	2,962.22	-0.5	-2.0	20.1
MSCI World	4,807.71	-1.2	-0.3	9.3
MSCI EAFE	3,100.07	-0.8	-0.5	8.9
MSCI Emerging Markets	1,620.66	-4.1	-5.8	16.7

Fixed Income[†]

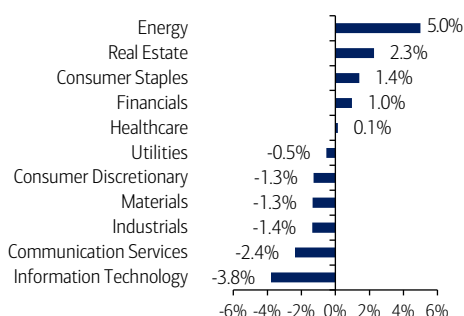
	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	WTD	MTD	YTD
Fixed Income				
Corporate & Government	4.74	0.12	-0.47	0.02
Agencies	4.49	0.16	-0.06	0.55
Municipals	3.73	-0.40	-0.80	1.50
U.S. Investment-Grade Credit	4.83	0.13	-0.45	0.16
International	5.31	0.07	-0.70	0.15
High Yield	7.18	0.03	0.15	2.11
90 Day Yield	3.79	3.78	3.81	3.63
2 Year Yield	4.18	4.21	4.17	3.47
10 Year Yield	4.55	4.56	4.47	4.17
30 Year Yield	5.07	5.06	4.95	4.84

Commodities & Currencies

	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	WTD	MTD	YTD
Commodities				
Bloomberg Commodity	337.51	3.6	6.8	22.2
WTI Crude \$/Barrel ^{††}	82.49	15.5	18.7	43.7
Gold Spot \$/Ounce ^{††}	4017.39	-2.5	0.2	-7.0

	Total Return in USD (%)			
	Current	Prior Week End	Prior Month End	2025 Year End
Currencies				
EUR/USD	1.14	1.14	1.14	1.17
USD/JPY	162.40	161.68	162.55	156.71
USD/CNH	6.78	6.78	6.79	6.98

S&P Sector Returns



Sources: Bloomberg, Factset. Total Returns from the period of 07/13/2026 to 07/17/2026. [†]Bloomberg Barclays Indices. ^{††}Spot price returns. All data as of the 07/17/2026 close. Data would differ if a different time period was displayed. Short-term performance shown to illustrate more recent trend. **Past performance is no guarantee of future results.**

Economic Forecasts (as of 7/17/2026)

Economic Forecasts	Q1 2026A	Q2 2026A	Q3 2026E	Q4 2026E	2026E	2027E
Real global GDP (% y/y annualized)	-	-	-	-	3.2	3.5
Real U.S. GDP (% q/q annualized)	2.1	2.5*	2.5	2.4	2.3	2.2
CPI inflation (% y/y)	2.7	3.8*	3.3	2.9	3.2	2.1
Core CPI inflation (% y/y)	2.5	2.7*	2.4	2.5	2.5	2.5
Unemployment rate (%)	4.3	4.3	4.3	4.2	4.3	4.2
Fed funds rate, end period (%)	3.63	3.63	3.88	4.38	4.38	4.38

The forecasts in the table above are the base line view from BofA Global Research. The Global Wealth & Investment Management (GWIM) Investment Strategy Committee (ISC) may make adjustments to this view over the course of the year and can express upside/downside to these forecasts. Historical data is sourced from Bloomberg, FactSet, and Haver Analytics. **There can be no assurance that the forecasts will be achieved. Economic or financial forecasts are inherently limited and should not be relied on as indicators of future investment performance.** A = Actual. E/* = Estimate. Data as of July 17, 2026.

Sources: BofA Global Research; GWIM ISC as of July 17, 2026.

Asset Class Weightings (as of 7/7/2026)

Asset Class	CIO View		
	Underweight	Neutral	Overweight
Global Equities	•	•	•
U.S. Large-cap Growth	•	•	•
U.S. Large-cap Value	•	•	•
U.S. Small-cap Growth	•	•	•
U.S. Small-cap Value	•	•	•
International Developed	•	•	•
Emerging Markets	•	•	•
Global Fixed Income	•	•	•
U.S. Governments	•	•	•
U.S. Mortgages	•	•	•
U.S. Corporates	•	•	•
International Fixed Income	•	•	•
High Yield	•	•	•
U.S. Investment-grade Tax Exempt	•	•	•
U.S. High Yield Tax Exempt	•	•	•
Alternative Investments*			
Hedge Strategies			
Private Equity			
Private Credit			
Real Assets			
Cash			

* Many products that pursue Alternative Investment strategies, specifically Private Equity and Hedge Funds, are available only to qualified investors. CIO asset class views are relative to the CIO Strategic Asset Allocation (SAA) of a multi-asset portfolio. Source: Chief Investment Office as of July 7, 2026. All sector and asset allocation recommendations must be considered in the context of an individual investor's goals, time horizon, liquidity needs and risk tolerance. Not all recommendations will be in the best interest of all investors.

CIO Equity Sector Views

Sector	CIO View		
	Underweight	Neutral	Overweight
Industrials	•	•	•
Consumer Discretionary	•	•	•
Financials	•	•	•
Information Technology	•	•	•
Energy	•	•	•
Materials	•	•	•
Utilities	•	•	•
Healthcare	•	•	•
Communication Services	•	•	•
Real Estate	•	•	•
Consumer Staples	•	•	•

Index Definitions

Securities indexes assume reinvestment of all distributions and interest payments. Indexes are unmanaged and do not take into account fees or expenses. It is not possible to invest directly in an index. Indexes are all based in U.S. dollars.

S&P 500 Index is a stock market index tracking the stock performance of 500 leading companies listed on stock exchanges in the United States.

S&P 500 Equal-Weighted Index is an alternative version of the standard S&P 500. While it includes the exact same 500 companies, it assigns an equal fixed weight to every stock—roughly 0.2%—regardless of a company's physical size or market capitalization.

Institute for Supply Management Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index is a monthly economic indicator that measures the health of the U.S. manufacturing sector.

Institute for Supply Management Services Purchasing Managers' Index is a monthly economic indicator measuring the health of the U.S. service sector.

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Asset allocation, diversification and rebalancing do not ensure a profit or protect against loss in declining markets.

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Alternative investments are intended for qualified investors only. Alternative Investments such as derivatives, hedge funds, private credit, private equity funds, and funds of funds can result in higher return potential but also higher loss potential. Changes in economic conditions or other circumstances may adversely affect your investments. Before you invest in alternative investments, you should consider your overall financial situation, how much money you have to invest, your need for liquidity, and your tolerance for risk.

Nonfinancial assets, such as closely held businesses, real estate, fine art, oil, gas and mineral properties, and timber, farm and ranch land, are complex in nature and involve risks including total loss of value. Special risk considerations include natural events (for example, earthquakes or fires), complex tax considerations, and lack of liquidity. Nonfinancial assets are not in the best interest of all investors. Always consult with your independent attorney, tax advisor, investment manager, and insurance agent for final recommendations and before changing or implementing any financial, tax, or estate planning strategy.

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